

IELTS Writing Essay Checklist Mini

Book 5 of 5 · Final checks before you submit

Stratum IELTS · stratumielts.com

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Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Series map

#	Book	Focus
1	Task 2 Structure Pack	Essay structure
2	Task 1 Charts Pack	Academic reports
3	Band 7 Vocabulary Pack	Vocabulary
4	Common Mistakes Pack	Error repair
5	Essay Checklist Mini (this book)	Final checks

How to use this book

Print the checklists or keep them on a second screen.

Use **Task 2 list** for essays and **Task 1 list** for reports.

Spend the last 5 minutes of every practice on these checks only.

Contents

1. 2-minute planning card
 2. Task 2 submit checklist
 3. Task 1 submit checklist
 4. 5-minute edit routine
 5. Self-score card
 6. Weekly practice tracker
 7. Next step on the site
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1. 2-minute planning card

Copy this before every Task 2:

Question type: _____
Position in one sentence: _____
Body 1 idea: _____
Body 1 example: _____
Body 2 idea: _____
Body 2 example: _____
Did I cover every part of the question? Yes / No

If "No", fix the plan before writing.

2. Task 2 submit checklist

Content

- ☐ I answered the exact question
- ☐ My position is easy to find
- ☐ I have two clear main ideas
- ☐ Each idea has explanation + example
- ☐ Conclusion matches introduction
- ☐ No new idea in conclusion

Organisation

- ☐ 4 clear paragraphs (typical)
- ☐ One idea per body paragraph
- ☐ Linking is natural, not forced

Language

- ☐ Word count 250+
- ☐ Articles checked (*a/the*)
- ☐ Subject-verb agreement checked
- ☐ No informal words
- ☐ Key nouns paraphrased in intro

3. Task 1 submit checklist

Content

- ☐ Introduction paraphrases the task
- ☐ Overview shows main trends/differences
- ☐ Key features selected (not every number)
- ☐ Comparisons are clear

- ☐ No personal opinion

Language

- ☐ Word count 150+
- ☐ Correct tense for the time period
- ☐ Data is accurate
- ☐ Units included where needed (% / million / etc.)

4. 5-minute edit routine

Use this exact order:

Minute	Check
1	Question coverage + position
2	Paragraph unity (one idea each)
3	Verbs and agreement
4	Articles and countable nouns
5	Spelling of topic words + word count

Do not rewrite the whole essay in the last five minutes. Repair only high-impact errors.

5. Self-score card

Answer Yes/No quickly after writing:

Check	Yes/No
Exact question answered?	
Position clear in 10 seconds?	
Two body ideas clearly different?	
Overview present (Task 1)?	
Most sentences clear on first reading?	
Repeated personal grammar mistakes avoided?	

Interpretation

- 5–6 Yes → submit and get external feedback

- 3–4 Yes → rewrite the weakest paragraph
- 0–2 Yes → rebuild from Book 1 or Book 2 templates

6. Weekly practice tracker

Day	Task	Prompt / chart	Checklist used	Checker feedback focus	Rewrite done?
Mon	T2				
Tue	T1				
Wed	T2				
Thu	T1				
Fri	T2				
Sat	Review mistakes (Book 4)				
Sun	Rest or light vocabulary (Book 3)				

Target: **5 checked pieces per week**, not 20 unchecked drafts.

7. Next step on Stratum IELTS

1. Finish checklist.
2. Paste your writing into the checker at <https://stratumielts.com>.
3. Note the top 2 weaknesses.
4. Rewrite once.
5. Return to the matching book:
 - structure → Book 1
 - charts → Book 2
 - wording → Book 3
 - repeated errors → Book 4

Quick one-page summary

Task 2: plan → 4 paragraphs → answer fully → edit 5 minutes

Task 1: overview first → key features only → accurate data → edit

Always: clear message beats rare vocabulary

Practise and check: stratumielts.com

About this booklet

Published by **Stratum IELTS** · stratumielts.com

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